

Dorđe Klisura

Assistant Professor of IS and Security
[Google Scholar](#)

Contact

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📧 Personal Website

Research Interests

- Trustworthy AI, Permission-aware language models, AI-driven cybersecurity

Education

- **The University of Texas at San Antonio** San Antonio, TX, USA
Ph.D. in Information Technology (Focus: Cybersecurity) Aug 2022 – May 2026
 - GPA: 3.98 / 4.00
 - Chair: Dr. Anthony Rios
 - Committee: Dr. Philip Menard, Dr. Ram Krishnan, Dr. Nishant Vishwamitra
 - Thesis: *Enhancing Security and Fairness in Large Language Models for Sensitive and Regulated Applications*
- **Louisiana State University** Baton Rouge, LA, USA
Visiting Ph.D. Coursework (6 credit hours) Aug 2023 – Dec 2023
- **University of Primorska, FAMNIT** Koper, Slovenia
M.Sc. in Data Science Oct 2020 – Aug 2022
- **University of Turku** Turku, Finland
M.Sc. Thesis Research (Advisor: Dr. Leo Lahti) Jan 2022 – Jul 2022
- **University of Coimbra** Coimbra, Portugal
Erasmus+ Exchange Program Feb 2021 – Jun 2021
- **University of Primorska, FAMNIT** Koper, Slovenia
B.Sc. in Computer Science Oct 2017 – Sep 2020

Appointments

- **Assistant Professor of Information Systems and Security (Tenure-Track)** Kennesaw, GA
Kennesaw State University – Coles College of Business Aug 2026 – Present
- **Data Science for Social Good (DSSG) Fellow** Baltimore, MD
The Johns Hopkins University May – Jul 2026
- **Graduate Research Assistant** San Antonio, TX
UT San Antonio ISC Department Aug 2022 – May 2026
- **Visiting Research Assistant** Baton Rouge, LA
LSU Division of Computer Science and Engineering (CSE) Aug 2023 – Dec 2023
- **Cybersecurity Simulation Designer (NATO 2023)** Remote
NATO Allied Command Transformation ([Letter of Commendation](#)) May 2023 – Nov 2023
- **Applied ML Research Intern** Turku, Finland
UTU Department of Computing ([Internship Report](#)) Feb 2022 – Jul 2022

Awards & Honors

- **Outstanding Graduate Teaching Award | College of AI, Cyber and Computing**
Named as the top graduate instructor at UT San Antonio CAICC Apr 2026
- **Ph.D. Student of The Year | UT San Antonio Alvarez College of Business**
Awarded to the top doctoral student across all Ph.D. programs Jul 2025
- **Ph.D. Student of The Year | Information Systems & Cybersecurity Dept.**
Awarded to the top doctoral student in the ISC Department Jul 2025
- **Second Place | STEM Spark: INFORMS K-12 Poster Competition**
Competition sponsored by INFORMS Education Outreach Committee Oct 2025
- **First Place Best Poster Award**
National Student Data Crops – 2024 Data Science Symposium Sep 2024

Publications

Journal Articles

1. I. Kuukkanen, G. Mulu, **Đorđe Klisura**, E. Kortela, A. Pietikäinen, L. Lahti, J. Hytönen, and M. Karonen. “Application of Mass Spectrometry-Based Metabolomics and Machine Learning in the Diagnostics of Lyme Neuroborreliosis”. In: *ACS Omega* (2026)
2. S. Torabi, **Đorđe Klisura**, J. Khoury, E. Bou-Harb, C. Assi, and M. Debbabi. “Internet-Wide Analysis, Characterization, and Family Attribution of IoT Malware: A Comprehensive Longitudinal Study”. In: *IEEE Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing* (2024)

Conference Papers

1. **Đorđe Klisura**, J. Khoury, A. Kundu, R. Krishnan, and A. Rios. “Role-Conditioned Refusals: Evaluating Access Control Reasoning in Large Language Models”. In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EACL 2026*. Association for Computational Linguistics, Mar. 2026. H5-index: 128
2. **Đorđe Klisura**, A. Bernaga, A. K. Gárate, R. Roshan, K. Yang, H. Pataci, and A. Rios. “A Multi-Agent Framework for Mitigating Dialect Biases in Privacy Policy Question-Answering Systems”. In: *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*. Association for Computational Linguistics, 2025. A* Conference. Acceptance rate: 21%; H5-index: 236
3. **Đorđe Klisura** and A. Rios. “Unmasking Database Vulnerabilities: Zero-Knowledge Schema Inference Attacks in Text-to-SQL Systems”. In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: NAACL 2025*. Association for Computational Linguistics, Apr. 2025, pp. 6954–6976. ISBN: 979-8-89176-195-7. H5-index: 126
4. T. Richardson, **Đorđe Klisura**, H. Pataci, and A. Rios. “FairPrivacy: A Robust Q&A System for Enhancing Transparency in IoT”. in: *AMCIS Proceedings*. 48. 2025
5. J. Khoury, **Đorđe Klisura**, H. Zanddizari, G. D. L. T. Parra, P. Najafirad, and E. Bou-Harb. “Jbeil: Temporal Graph-Based Inductive Learning to Infer Lateral Movement in Evolving Enterprise Networks”. In: *2024 IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (S&P)*. IEEE. 2024, 3644–3660. A*, Acceptance rate: 12%, H5-index: 110
6. V. Rammouz, J. Khoury, **Đorđe Klisura**, M. S. Pour, M. S. Pour, C. Fachkha, and E. Bou-Harb. “Helium-based IoT Devices: Threat Analysis and Internet-scale Exploitations”. In: *2023 19th International Conference on Wireless and Mobile Computing, Networking and Communications (WiMob)*. IEEE. 2023, pp. 206–211
7. M. Husák, J. Khoury, **Đorđe Klisura**, and E. Bou-Harb. “On the Provision of Network-Wide Cyber Situational Awareness via Graph-Based Analytics”. In: *International Conference on Complex Computational Ecosystems*. Springer. 2023, pp. 167–179

8. M. Husák, S. J. Jang, J. Khoury, **Đorđe Klisura**, and E. Bou-Harb. “Unraveling Network-based Pivoting Maneuvers: Empirical Insights and Challenges”. In: *14th EAI International Conference on Digital Forensics & Cyber Crime*. New York City, USA, Dec. 2023
9. **Đorđe Klisura**. “Embedding non-planar graphs: Storage and Representation”. In: *Proceedings of the 2021 7th Student Computer Science Research Conference*. 2021, p. 57

Workshops

1. R. Alvarez, P. Bhatt, **Đorđe Klisura**, and K. K. Choo. “Predicting game cheating behavior through the social network”. In: *Dewald Roode Workshop on Information Systems Security Research*. Vol. 8. 2023

Preprints & Working Papers

1. **Đorđe Klisura**, F. Džihó, P. Menard, A. Rios. *Reducing Dialect-Induced Refusal Disparities in Large Language Models with Prompt-Probe-Gated Decoding*. arXiv preprint.
2. V. Rammouz, **Đorđe Klisura**, A. Rios. *Mechanistic Access Control in Large Language Models via Latent Refusal Probing*. arXiv preprint.

Teaching & Mentorship

- **Fall 2026: IS-Code Class**
University Instructor
- **Fall 2025: IS-2053 Programming I**
Primary instructor
- **Spring 2025: IS-2053 Programming I**
Primary instructor
 - Overall Instructor Rating: **4.66 / 5.0**
 - [View Full Student Evaluation](#) →
- **Fall 2023: LSU University Laboratory School**
Curriculum development and teaching for high school students.
 - Co-developed and taught hands-on cybersecurity modules to high school students as part of an outreach initiative within the experiential CSC 7700 course at Louisiana State University (LSU).
- **Summer 2024: UT San Antonio School of Data Science**
Immersion Program - Graduate Student Mentor
 - Mentored graduate student Astrid Bernaga (from Tecnológico de Monterrey) on a two-month research project, culminating in a poster presentation and an ACL publication.

Research Presentations

- **Texas NLP Symposium 2026** College Station, TX
Poster Presentation Apr 2, 2026
- **Fall Workshop on Cybersecurity and AI** San Angelo, TX
Poster Presentation Oct 7 – 8, 2025
- **ACL 2025** Vienna, Austria
Poster Presentation Jul 27 – Aug 1, 2025
- **NAACL 2025** Albuquerque, NM
Poster presentation Apr 29 – May 3, 2025
- **Alamo Regional Data Alliance SPARK Conference** San Antonio, TX
Oral Presentation; Emerging Voices: Data Ethics at the Human-AI Intersection Apr 17, 2025
- **Biz AI: AI Applications in Business Research** Dallas, TX
Poster presentation Mar 28 – 30, 2025
- **15th Annual Machine Learning Symposium** New York City, NY
Poster Presentation Oct 18, 2024

Professional Services

- *Reviewer:* The International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), 2026
- *Reviewer:* IEEE Transactions on Network and Service Management (TNSM) 2026, 2025, 2024, 2023
- *Reviewer:* The Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025
- *Reviewer:* Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2025
- *Reviewer:* IEEE Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing (TDSC), 2025
- *Reviewer:* IEEE Access, 2024
- *Reviewer:* IEEE Internet of Things Magazine 2023, 2022
- *Reviewer:* IEEE Wireless Communications and Networking Conference (WCNC), 2023
- *Sub-Reviewer:* EMNLP 2024; ACL Rolling Review 2024; ARES 2024, 2023
- *Program Committee Member:* ARES The 4th Intl. Workshop on Graph-based Approaches for CyberSecurity (GRASEC), 2023

Professional Development

- **Exploring Business and Culture in an Emerging Economy** Mysore, India
UT San Antonio Study Abroad Program (3 credit hours) Aug 1 – 10, 2025
 - Completed the UT San Antonio-led International Summer Immersion Program in Mysore, Karnataka, India, combining seminars and workshops on AI in cybersecurity, fintech, entrepreneurship, CSR, creative industries, and transportation with cultural activities including heritage site visits and industry tours.
- **Weatherhead Symposium 2025: AI and the Future of Work** Cleveland, OH
Attendee Apr 24, 2025

- Participated in a full-day symposium exploring the impact of artificial intelligence on workplaces, organizational structures, and the future global economy, featuring industry leaders, academics, and flash talks on cutting-edge topics.

- **Data and AI Intensive Research with Rigor and Reproducibility (DAIR³)** Jackson, MS
Participant with a Full Scholarship Award (Certificate) Jul 28 – Aug 2, 2024
 - Selected for the DAIR³ program, a competitive bootcamp followed by a year-long mentorship initiative organized by the Michigan Institute for Data Science (MIDAS), focused on ethical data practices, reproducible workflows, and rigorous analytical design in data science and AI. Under the mentorship of Dr. Gregory Hunt (William & Mary University), I developed an implementation plan for integrating DAIR³ best practices into my IS-2053 Python Programming course at UT San Antonio, which was successfully piloted in Spring 2025.
- **Berkeley-Stanford Workshop on Vertical Data Science** Berkeley, CA
Attendee May 31, 2024
 - Participated in a one-day workshop on veridical data science, exploring reproducible analysis and applications in trustworthy data science, machine learning, and AI.
- **MIDAS Annual Future Leaders Summit 2024** Ann Arbor, MI
Poster Presentation Apr 8 – 10, 2024
 - Selected by the ISCS Department to attend the 2024 MIDAS Annual Future Leaders Summit, presenting research on database system security and contributing to discussions on responsible and explainable AI.

Grants & Scholarships

- **UT San Antonio Travel Grants & Research Support** San Antonio, TX
PhD Excellence Fund (4x), Grad. Prof. Dev. Grant (3x), IEF Scholarship 2024–2025
- **DAIR³ Scholarship** Ann Arbor, MI
MIDAS, University of Michigan Jul 2024
- **Travel Grant** Berkeley, CA
UC Berkeley Summer Institute Jun 2024
- **Research Grant** Turku, Finland
UTU Department of Computing Mar 2022
- **The Three ERASMUS+ Scholarships** Finland, Austria, Portugal
EU-funded mobility programs (study, research, internship) 2021–2022
- **Academic Excellence Scholarship** Koper, Slovenia
University of Primorska Oct 2021 – Aug 2022
- **NLB Bank Scholarship** Ljubljana, Slovenia
NLB Group (national competition) Mar – Sep 2022

Credentials

- **Data and AI Intensive Research (DAIR³)**
Michigan Institute for Data Science May 2025
- **PH525.3x: Statistical Inference and Modeling for High-throughput Experiments**
Harvard University (Certificate) Feb 2023
- **SAS Certified Associate: Programming Fundamentals using SAS 9.4**
SAS Institute (Certificate) Dec 2022

- **Machine Learning Onramp**
MathWorks *Mar 2021*
- **Faculty Development Programme on Cyber Security and Cryptography**
Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee *Oct 2020*

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages (advanced):** Python (*pandas, NumPy, PyTorch, TensorFlow, PyTorch-Lightning*), R/RStudio, Java/JavaScript
- **Programming Languages (working):** MATLAB, SAS, Stata, PHP, HTML/CSS
- **Machine Learning & NLP:** scikit-learn, Hugging Face Transformers, spaCy, NLTK, LangChain, OpenAI / Llama / other Gen-AI models
- **Data & Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL (ETL design), Power BI, MicroStrategy, QGIS, HiView
- **DevOps & Reproducibility:** Git/GitHub, Docker, VS Code/Jupyter, LaTeX/biblatex, CI workflows
- **Languages:** Serbian (Native), English (Fluent), Slovenian (Fluent), Spanish (Basic)

Volunteering Experience

- **Volunteer Coordinator, ACL 2025**
Association for Computational Linguistics *Jul 2025*
- **Session Coordinator, MISQ AI-IA Workshop (WaIaNE)**
MIS Quarterly *Jul 2025*
- **Volunteer Coordinator, NAACL 2025**
Association for Computational Linguistics *May 2025*
- **Graduate Student Volunteer**
Northeast Big Data Innovation Hub *Jun 2023 – Sep 2024*

Memberships in Professional Societies

- **Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)**
Student Member *Jun 2025 – Present*
- **Order of the Sword & Shield (Omicron Sigma Sigma)**
Student Member - National Honor Society *Nov 2024 – Present*
– Recognized for academic excellence in homeland security, intelligence, emergency management, and protective security disciplines.
- **Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)**
Graduate Student Member - Lone Star Section *Jul 2024 – Present*
- **New York Academy of Sciences**
Student Member *Oct 2024 – Present*
- **Google Developer Student Clubs**
Student Member *Nov 2021 – Jun 2022*

Industry & Applied Experience

- **Software Developer**
Actual I.T.
Koper, Slovenia
Nov 2021 – Feb 2022
 - Shipped user-facing features in Vue/Java; implemented input validation and partnered with designers on UX refinements.
- **Data Analyst Trainee**
ClearKarma (Traineeship Report)
Vienna, Austria
Jul 2021 – Sep 2021
 - Ran market analyses and automated data-extraction workflows; defined data standards now embedded in the core platform.
- **Data Science Intern**
CRMT d.o.o.
Ljubljana, Slovenia
Feb 2021
 - Designed data-warehouse schema and ETL pipelines; transformed enterprise data with SQL for BI dashboards.
- **Web Developer (Project)**
University of Primorska, Faculty of Pedagogy
Koper, Slovenia
Jun 2020
 - Built departmental website end-to-end, iterating with faculty to improve accessibility and UX.